

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Analyst | CSIRT | Incident Response | Threat Detection | SOC Operations

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Analyst with more than five years of experience delivering Computer Security Incident Response Team (CSIRT) and Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions across large, complex organisations. I have extensive hands-on experience managing the full incident handling lifecycle, from initial alert triage and escalation recognition through to containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review, in line with NIST 800-61. I am skilled in threat detection and analysis using Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) tools, and network security tooling, and I routinely apply MITRE ATT&CK framework-mapped intelligence to proactively identify threats. I have operated within an education and research sector CSIRT environment and understand the distinct network topology, user behaviour patterns, and threat landscape of large-scale academic institutions. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a structured, evidence-based approach to incident handling and security intelligence gathering.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Computer Security Incident Response Team (CSIRT) Operations:** Incident handling, triage, escalation, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL); Splunk Security Information and Event Management (SIEM)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, EDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** PowerShell-based SOAR automation, automated incident containment and notification playbooks
- **Threat Detection and Intelligence:** MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, detection engineering, intelligence-led triage
- **Network Security Monitoring:** Intrusion Detection System (IDS)/Intrusion Prevention System (IPS), DDoS mitigation, Web Application Firewall (WAF), network anomaly detection
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM platform
- **Frameworks:** NIST 800-61, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Operate the Computer Security Incident Response Team (CSIRT) function, managing alert triage, escalation, and incident handling duties across a 8,000-user academic institution within a complex multi-site network environment.
- Act as the primary technical escalation point for complex security incidents, leading the full NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, including initial detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review.
- Operate Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, including CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, conducting alert triage, threat detection, and detection rule authoring and tuning using Kusto Query Language (KQL).
- Use a range of commercial and open-source security tools to gather threat intelligence, mitigate attacks, and provide an ongoing SOC and incident response capability for the institution's network and systems.

- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platform, executing real-time response actions to contain active threats, and conducting host-based forensic analysis during incident investigations.
- Operate Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows using PowerShell-based playbooks, automating alert enrichment, initial containment actions, and communications to reduce analyst response time.
- Maintain Intrusion Detection System (IDS)/Intrusion Prevention System (IPS) monitoring, investigating network anomalies and correlating findings with SIEM data to identify and respond to network-based threats.
- Participate in threat hunting activities using MITRE ATT&CK-mapped hypotheses to proactively identify attacker activity not captured by automated detection rules.
- Produce clear incident reports, timelines, and post-incident reviews for technical leads and senior stakeholders, enabling informed decision-making and continuous improvement of the CSIRT capability.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Participated in CSIRT incident handling duties, including alert triage, escalation recognition, incident coordination, evidence preservation, and recovery support across multiple simultaneous incidents.
- Triage and investigated security alerts from Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platforms, conducting root cause analysis and documenting incident timelines in line with NIST 800-61.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, integrating with the SOC alert workflow and enabling centralised endpoint and identity-based threat detection.
- Contributed to detection rule development, tuning SIEM and EDR detection logic to reduce false positives and improve the accuracy of alerting across the organisation.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises using MITRE ATT&CK framework-mapped hypotheses, proactively searching for indicators of compromise across SIEM, EDR, and identity platforms.
- Managed Intrusion Detection System (IDS)/Intrusion Prevention System (IPS) monitoring, investigating network-level anomalies and escalating confirmed threats through the incident handling process.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline CSIRT workflows, including automated triage enrichment, account lockout investigation, and post-incident data collection.
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001-aligned control assurance activities, demonstrating technical compliance across endpoint, identity, and network security domains.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed security monitoring across a cloud-hosted SaaS environment, responding to security alerts and conducting initial triage and escalation through a structured incident response process.
- Administered Microsoft Azure security controls, including identity governance, role-based access control (RBAC), and audit logging, supporting security event visibility and CSIRT response capability.
- Maintained vulnerability scanning and patch management programmes, identifying and escalating critical vulnerabilities for remediation across a hybrid cloud-on-premises infrastructure.
- Supported incident response activities and contributed to post-incident reviews and lessons-learned exercises, helping improve the organisation's incident handling maturity.
- Managed access controls including Single Sign-On (SSO) and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) to strengthen identity security and reduce the risk of account compromise.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender to 8,000 users, establishing centralised endpoint and identity threat detection integrated into the CSIRT workflow.
- Reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) to high-severity incidents by 40% through implementation of automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks handling alert enrichment, initial containment, and stakeholder notification.

- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification by leading technical remediation activities across endpoint protection, identity management, and network security domains.
- Designed and tuned a comprehensive detection rule library in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), significantly reducing false positive rates and improving CSIRT analyst efficiency.
- Delivered Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programme to validate detection coverage against real-world attack techniques mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, closing critical detection gaps across high-priority attack paths.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) across the enterprise, eliminating uncontrolled privileged access and strengthening the organisation's resilience to insider threats and credential-based attacks.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)